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Unit 4 : Session 1 : SLO 2 | Functional vs Imperative Paradigms

■ I. Discussion Question

- A pure functional approach is better for adding two numbers because the operation is a pure function: given the same two inputs it always returns the same result, with no dependence on and no modification of any external state.
- Predictability: `add(2, 3)` is always 5, regardless of when or how many times it is called, whereas an imperative version may read or mutate global variables, so results can change with program state.
- Testability: pure functions need no setup or mocks they can be unit-tested in isolation.
- Referential transparency: any call can be replaced by its result, enabling safe refactoring, caching (memoization) and parallelism.
- No side effects: the calculator's other features can never be accidentally corrupted by the addition logic, which is a real risk with imperative state mutation.